

Like the Way I Do -- Melissa Etheridge

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. Full board.

From *Melissa Etheridge* (1988). ~80 BPM base pulse, though the song's intensity keeps climbing well past what that tempo alone suggests -- a moody, harmonica-laced intro building through the verses into one of her most raw, unhinged vocal performances by the end.

This is the same "quiet build to massive climax" shape as a few other patches in this set, but the character is different -- raw, bluesy, rootsy rock rather than symphonic or gospel. The climax here isn't cathedral-scale, it's visceral: driving, gritty, right in-your-face rather than washed in reverb.

CTL off = the moody, restrained intro/verse. CTL on = the raw, driving climax.

GP-5 settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB.

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 22
- Always on. Moderate threshold -- there's real distortion once the DST engages for the climax, needs cleanup between notes.

PRE -- Micro Boost -- On CTL

- Gain: 55
- CTL off: bypassed (intro/verse). CTL on: engaged (climax).
- Adds extra push on top of the DST engagement for the full-intensity outro.

DST -- Darktale (ProCo Rat, LM308) -- On CTL

- Gain: 65, Filter: 45, VOL: 62
- CTL off: bypassed (intro/verse -- amp alone, some natural grit but not distorted). CTL on: engaged (climax).
- The Rat's raw, slightly fuzzy, mid-forward character is a better fit here than a cleaner, more polished distortion -- this song's intensity is rootsy and unhinged, not slick.

AMP -- Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT)

- Gain: 32, Bass: 58, Middle: 55, MidFreq: 800Hz, Treble: 52, VOL: 65
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- SVT is a genuine blues-rock workhorse amp -- gives real body and a bit of natural edge even at a moderate Gain, which fits the slightly-raw character this song has even in its quieter moments. The Darktale module is what pushes it into full aggression for the climax, not the AMP itself.

CAB -- User IR 3 (Apg810)

- VOL: 62
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- Ampeg SVT-810E -- the direct real-world pairing for the Classic Bass AMP model above, giving this the weight to carry both the restrained intro and the driving climax.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: +3, 150Hz: 0, 600Hz: +3, 2kHz: +3, 8kHz: +1, VOL: 55
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- +3 at 600Hz gives this a bluesy midrange growl that's present even before the distortion kicks in. +3 at 2kHz keeps it defined once the band and the DST both push harder for the climax.

MOD -- Off

- No modulation. Raw and direct, matching the song's rootsy, unpolished character.

DLY -- Off

- Not used.

RVB -- Room -- On CTL (inverted)

- Mix: 20, Decay: 30, Trail: On
- CTL off: engaged (intro/verse). CTL on: bypassed (climax).
- Inverted on purpose -- the moody intro gets a touch of room for atmosphere, but the climax needs to stay dry and in-your-face. This isn't a symphonic, reverb-washed payoff like "November Rain" or "Purple Rain" -- it's raw and visceral, so the reverb drops out right when the intensity peaks.

CAB IR -- Apg810 (Slot 3)

- Ampeg SVT-810E, confirmed loaded on User IR slot 3 -- the classic "wall of Ampeg" bass stack.
- Encoded directly into the `.prst` as a real, active CAB reference (`User IR 3`) -- no manual loading needed for this one.

CTL summary

- **CTL Off -- Intro/verse.** Moody, restrained, a touch of room ambience. Some natural amp edge but no real distortion.
- **CTL On -- Climax.** Darktale and Micro Boost engage, Room drops out -- raw, dry, driving, matching the song's most intense, unhinged moment.
- Engage CTL as the song builds into its final full-intensity section and leave it on through to the end.

Full pedalboard (signal chain order)

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. No octave layering needed for this raw, direct rock tone.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged

- COMP: 48
- TONE: 55
- LEVEL: 58
- Mode: TREBLE
- Moderate compression keeps this consistent across both the restrained intro and the driven climax.

TREBLE mode keeps attack alive once the Darktale kicks in.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. The GP-5's own Darktale gives a more controlled Rat-style crunch than a fuzz would -- the right call for a bluesy, driving rock intensity rather than a wall of noise.

4. Joyo Tidal Wave -- Engaged

- Drive: 25
- Blend: 50
- Presence: 58
- Level: 58
- Treble: 55
- Middle: 55
- Bass: 55
- Mid-Frequency: 500Hz
- Bass-Shift: 40Hz
- Cab-Sim (DI out): Off
- Ground Lift: Off
- Adds body and presence feeding the amp. Bass-Shift at 40Hz keeps things fuller and warmer rather than tight -- this is rootsy blues-rock, not punk or metal precision.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. No chorus -- matches the MOD-off call on the GP-5. Raw, direct tone throughout.

6. Valeton GP-5 -- see settings above.